

2006 Hundreds die in an attempted coup against President Déby.

2008 Rebel offensive reaches outskirts of N'Djamena before it is repelled.

2010 The Chad-Sudan border is opened again after a seven-year closure.

«280–81 The Slave Trade

Sudan



Africa's largest country, divided between a Muslim north and an animist and Christian south.

c.1580–1050 BCE New Kingdom in Egypt expands its frontiers up the Nile River south into Nubia (the north of modern Sudan). By the 11th century BCE, Egyptian control of Nubia is weakened and a separate kingdom is established in Kush, farther to the south, which between 770–716 BCE conquers Egypt.

641 CE Muslim Arabs conquer what is now Sudan. At this time the name “Sudan” is generally used to refer to the whole belt of territory immediately south of the Sahara, known in Arabic as “bilad al-Sudan” or the “land of the black men.”

1821 Northern Sudan is conquered by the viceroy of Egypt, Mohammed Ali. Trade routes are opened up through the southern Sudd swamps. Slave trade kills much of the southern population.

1874–80 The Sudan is administered for the Egyptian viceroy by the British General Gordon.

1881 Muhammad Ahmed el-Mahdi declares a holy war against the Egyptian administration in Khartoum.

1882 British take over Egypt.

1883 Muslim revolt led by the Mahdi, whose forces capture Khartoum in 1885.

1898 Mahdists are defeated by the British at Omdurman.

1954 Becomes self-governing.

1955 Rebellion in the south starts 17-year-long civil war.

1956 Gains independence as republic.

1958–64 Military rule.

1965 Civilian revolution: elections held.

1969 Military coup led by Colonel Jaafar Nimeiri.

1972 South gets limited autonomy.

1973 Sudanese Socialist Union is sole party.

1983 Southern rebellion resumes.

1984 Devastating drought.

1989 General Omar Bashir takes over.

1991 Sharia penal code is instituted.

2001 Bashir ousts fundamentalist al-Turabi from leadership. New attempts to make peace with southern rebels.

2003 Pro-government Arab “Janjaweed” militias carry out systematic killings of African villagers in the Darfur region, an act seen by many as genocide.

2005 New constitution grants the south degree of autonomy. Former rebel leader John Garang becomes vice president, but dies in a helicopter crash.

2006 Fighting continues in Darfur as the smaller rebel groups reject the peace settlement.

2007 A United Nations peacekeeping mission for Darfur is established.

2009 The International Criminal Court issues a warrant for the arrest of President Bashir of Sudan on charges of genocide.

2010 The Justice and Equality Movement (JEM), the main rebel group in Darfur, signs peace accord with the government.

2011 Referendum in the south votes overwhelmingly for secession.

«174–75 The Ascent of Islam
«360–61 The Scramble for Africa

Egypt



Home to one of the world's oldest civilizations, which emerged along the Nile.

c.3000 BCE With the foundation of the Old Kingdom, the fertile lands of Upper and Lower Egypt along the Nile are united for the first time.

c.2060–1785 BCE The Middle Kingdom expands trade with Asia, but Egyptian expansion up the Nile into Nubia is then stalled by nomadic Hyksos invaders from the east in 1730 BCE.

c.1580–1050 BCE The New Kingdom resumes expansion of Egypt's frontiers to the south and into Mesopotamia.

525–402 BCE Persians conquer Egypt, and again in 343–332 BCE.

332 BCE Alexander the Great conquers Egypt and moves the capital to Alexandria on the Mediterranean, founded in 331 BCE.

304 BCE After the death of Alexander in 323 BCE, Egypt eventually passes to one of his generals, who rules as Ptolemy I.

51 BCE Last of the Ptolemaic dynasty, Cleopatra, becomes ruler of Egypt.

31 BCE Naval battle of Actium: Cleopatra defeated by the Romans. After her suicide

DECISIVE MOMENT

SUEZ CRISIS, 1956

On July 26, 1956, Egypt's president, Gamal Abdel Nasser, nationalized the Suez Canal, the shares in which were owned by UK and French investors. Fearful that Egypt's assertion of sovereignty would result in an Arab attack, Israel invaded Sinai. When both sides refused to halt military action, UK and French forces attacked Port Said on October 6 (right) in order to seize the canal. Pressure from the UN and US forced a humiliating ceasefire on the UK and France. The UN stationed troops to keep Israel and Egypt apart. The crisis marked the end of British influence in the region.



in 30 BCE, Egypt becomes part of the Roman and successor Byzantine empires.

641–42 CE Byzantine Empire loses Egypt to Muslim invaders from Arabia, who introduce Arabic and Islam.

868–905 Tulunid dynasty wrests control of Egypt from the Abbasid Caliphate.

969 Shia Fatimids make Cairo their capital.

1169–71 Saladin takes Egypt and founds the short-lived Ayyubid dynasty.

1250 Mamluks, slave soldiers, mainly of Circassian origin, take power.

1517 Cairo is captured by Turks; Egypt becomes part of the Ottoman Empire.

1798 Napoleon invades Egypt, but his fleet is destroyed by the British at the Battle of the Nile at Aboukir Bay.

1805 Mohammed Ali, an Albanian in the Turkish army, seizes power. Ottomans recognize him as Viceroy of Egypt.

1869 The Suez Canal is opened.

1882 British forces occupy Cairo. Egypt effectively under British rule, although still part of the Ottoman Empire.

1914 Britain makes Egypt a protectorate.

1922 Britain grants Egypt limited independence. Sultan Ahmed Fuad becomes King Fuad and rules until his death in 1936, when he is succeeded by his son King Farouk.

1924 The first democratic election held under the 1923 constitution brings Wafd Party leader Saad Zaghlul to power.

1936 The Anglo-Egyptian treaty ends the British military presence in Egypt. During World War II Britain defends Egypt; Axis forces are repulsed at El Alamein in November 1942.

1948 The first Arab-Israeli war ends in defeat for Egypt.

1952 Free Officers' Movement, led by General Neguib, forces Farouk to abdicate. Constitution is suspended.

1953 A republic is proclaimed with Neguib as president.

1954 Gamal Abdel Nasser deposes Neguib and becomes president.

1956 Suez Crisis over nationalization of Suez Canal. Israeli, British, and French forces withdraw after pressure from UN.

1960–70 Building of Aswan Dam.

1967 Sinai is lost in the Six Day War with Israel.

1970 Nasser dies of a heart attack and is succeeded by Anwar Sadat.

1972 Soviet military advisers are dismissed from Egypt.

1974–75 US brokers partial Israeli withdrawal from Sinai.

1977 Sadat visits Jerusalem for first-ever meeting with Israeli prime minister.

1978 Camp David accords, brokered by US, signed by Egypt and Israel.

1981 Sadat is assassinated by Islamist extremists; succeeded by Hosni Mubarak.

1986 President Mubarak meets Israeli prime minister Shimon Peres to discuss Middle East peace.

1994–98 Islamist extremist terror campaign, killing civilians and tourists.

2005 Mubarak is reelected for fifth consecutive term as president.

2006 1,000 people die in Red Sea ferry sinking.

2011 Mubarak resigns after 18 days of street protests in Cairo. The Armed Forces Supreme Council takes power.

«56–57 The Divine Pharaohs
«64–65 Egypt in Order and Chaos
«66–67 Rameses II
«68–69 Realm of Osiris
«70–71 Ancient Egyptian Life
«72–73 Building for Eternity
«118–19 Greek and Roman Egypt
«158–59 Diffusion of Knowledge
«412–13 End of the Colonial Era